

Passages - Apology

I am wiser than him in just this one small detail, that when I don't know something, I don't think I know it either.

I speak with absolutely no concealment or reservation. I'm pretty sure it is this way of speaking which makes me unpopular. My unpopularity is the proof that I am speaking the truth, that this is the prejudice against me, and these are the reasons for it.

You are wrong, sir, If you think that a man who is worth anything at all should take into account the chances of life and death. No, the only thing he should think about, when he acts, is whether he is acting rightly or wrongly, and whether this is the behaviour of a good man or a bad man.

It is essential that the true fighter for justice, if he is to survive for even a short time, should remain a private individual and not go into public life.

the unexamined life is not worth living

In any kind of danger there are all sorts of other devices for avoiding death, if you can bring yourself not to mind what you do or say. There's no difficulty in that, gentlemen - in escaping death. What is much harder is avoiding wickedness, since wickedness runs faster than death.

Suppose it's a total absence of consciousness. Like sleep, when the sleeper isn't even dreaming...If death is something like that, I call it a benefit. Seen in this way, the whole of time seems no longer than a single night.

I must stop. It is time for us to go. Me to my death, you to your lives. Which of us goes to the better fate, only god knows.